



▲ **European-styled** Sealdah station also served as a tram terminus till 1978. Today, one of the busiest, this railway station has three terminals: Sealdah North, Sealdah Main, and Sealdah South.

From simplicity to grandness

Plans for prominent stations in busy cities veered away from functionality to include decorative elements. Architectural styles incorporated in the designs of these stations echoed European trends. The original 1862 Sealdah station in Calcutta was constructed in the Italianate style, nostalgically placing a little slice of England in Bengal. Sealdah's low-pointed roof mirrored those of the stations found along England's Great Western Railway. This expansive terminus would later become a temporary home for Hindu-Bengali refugees fleeing East Pakistan after Partition in 1947. The Royapuram station in the Madras Presidency displayed characteristically Greek-style neoclassical features. Inaugurated in 1856, this station was the first in Madras and functioned as the region's premier terminus until 1907, after which further routes were extended, making Madras Central more prominent.